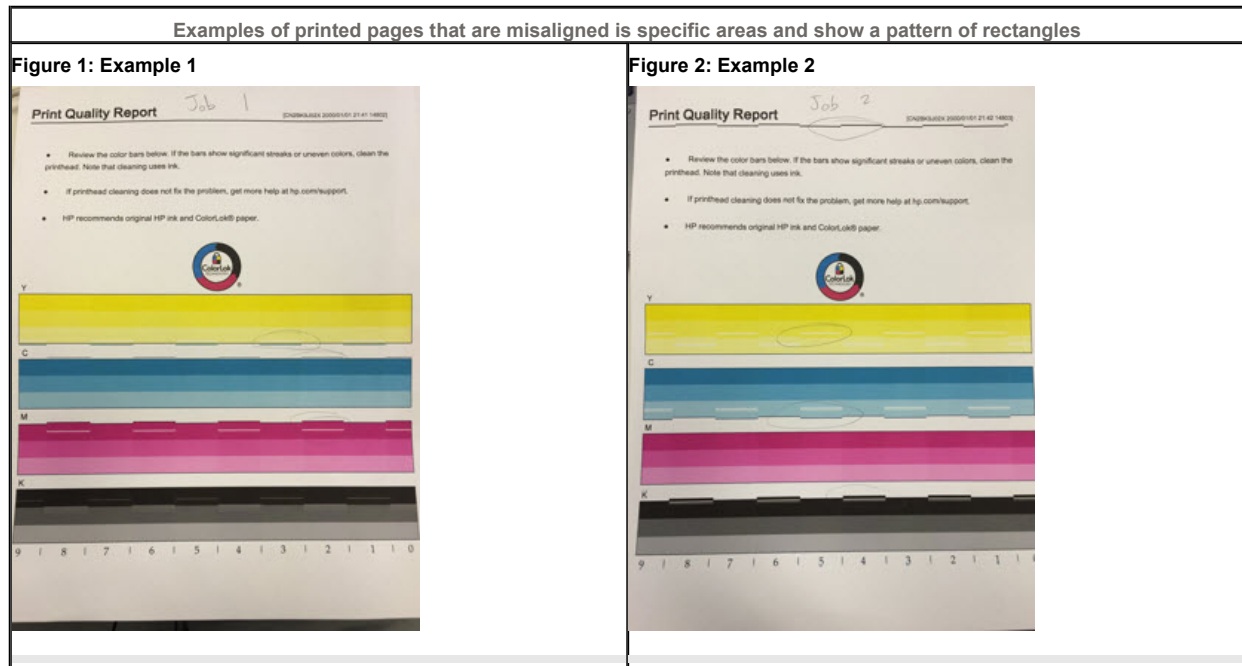


HP PageWide 300, 400, 500 series - Printed pages are misaligned in specific areas and show a pattern of rectangles

Issue

Printed pages are misaligned in specific areas and show a pattern of rectangles.



Possible Cause

The front encoder wheel (located inside the product under the control panel) might be damaged, causing the paper to move under the print bar faster or slower than it should.

Solution

If the encoder wheel is damaged beyond repair and needs to be replaced, the recommended solution is to replace the entire unit. However, in some cases, the front encoder wheel could just be dirty or dusty and simply requires cleaning.

To access and clean the encoder wheel, proceed with the steps below.

NOTE: The steps for cleaning the encoder wheel differ slightly between the PageWide product models.

For instructions that pertain to your product model, click one of the links below to skip to the appropriate section in this document, and then follow the steps provided.

- [PageWide 352, 377, 452, and 477 models](#)
- [PageWide 552 and 577 \(including the Managed P55250 and P57750 models\)](#)

PageWide 352, 377, 452, and 477 models

1. Press the Power button to turn off the printer, and then disconnect the power cord from the back of the printer.
2. Open the left door on the printer.
Optional: Remove the rear door to allow more space for performing this procedure.
3. Using a T10 screwdriver, remove the three screws (pictured below) from the back cover, and then remove the cover.

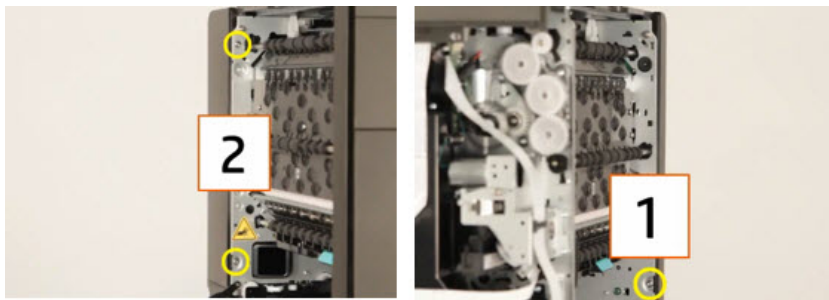
NOTE: Two of the screws are hidden in foam tips. You can use the screwdriver to remove the foam tips (as shown below).

Figure 3: Remove the three screws from the back cover (two are hidden in foam tips)



4. Remove the left-front and left-rear covers by removing the screws located on the inner walls of the metal frame (shown below).

Figure 4: Example of the screws on the inner walls of the metal frame on the left-side of the product



5. **For the 377 and 477 models only:** Partially remove the scanner assembly using the following steps:

NOTE: For the 352 and 452 models, skip to step 6.

- a. Using a flathead screwdriver, remove the scanner base plate located above the eject flap.
- b. Remove the two screws that hold the control panel in place (shown below), and then remove the control panel assembly.

Figure 5: Remove two screws that hold the control panel in place



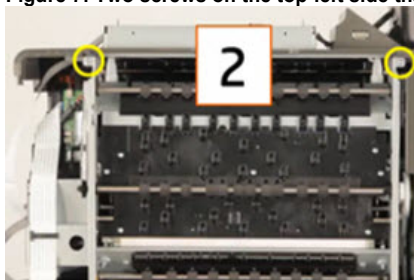
- c. In the small compartment where the control panel assembly used to sit, remove the three screws (shown below).

Figure 6: Remove three screws in the small compartment where the control panel used to sit



- d. Push the scanner assembly towards the left side and partially lift it so that it is on top of the scanner support bracket.
6. Remove the two screws on the top-left side of the printer that attach to the top cover (shown below).

Figure 7: Two screws on the top-left side that attach to the top cover



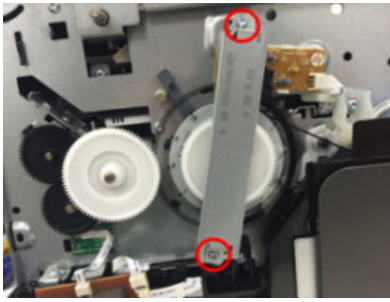
7. Partially remove the top cover (you will have to detach the top cover from the front cover).
8. Remove the screw on the front cover (shown below), and then remove the front cover.

Figure 8: Screw on front cover



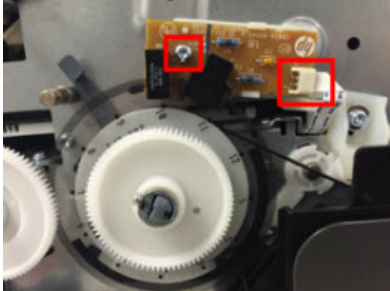
9. Remove the encoder-wheel brace by removing the two screws that are holding it in place.

Figure 9: Two screws on encoder-wheel brace



10. On the encoder-wheel PCA, disconnect the FFC and remove the screw. Then carefully remove the PCA.

Figure 10: Screw and FFC on encoder-wheel PCA



11. Using a clean, damp, lint-free cloth, carefully wipe the encoder wheel while gently turning the gear.

NOTE: Be careful not to scratch or damage the wheel.

Figure 11: Clean the encoder wheel



12. After you have cleaned the encoder wheel, reassemble the parts in the following order:
- Encoder wheel PCA
 - Encoder wheel brace
 - Front cover
 - Top cover
 - Left-front and left-rear covers
 - Rear cover

PageWide 552 and 577 (including the Managed P55250 and P57750 models)

- Press the Power button to turn off the printer, and then disconnect the power cord from the back of the printer.
- Open the left door on the printer.
Optional: Remove the rear door to allow more space for performing this procedure.
- Using a T10 screwdriver, remove the four screws (pictured below) from the back cover, and then remove the cover.

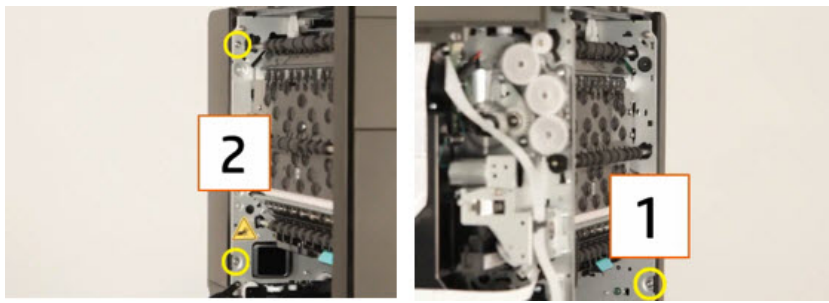
NOTE: All four screws are hidden in foam tips. You can use the screwdriver to remove the foam tips.

Figure 12: Four screws on back cover



4. Remove the left-front and left-rear covers by removing the screws located on the inner walls of the metal frame (shown below).

Figure 13: Example of the screws on the inner walls of the metal frame on the left-side of the product



5. **For the 577 model only:** Partially remove the scanner assembly using the following steps:

NOTE: For the 552 model, skip to step 6.

- a. Using a flathead screwdriver, remove the scanner base plate located above the eject flap.
- b. Remove the two screws that hold the control panel in place (shown below), and then remove the control panel assembly.

Figure 14: Remove two screws that hold the control panel in place



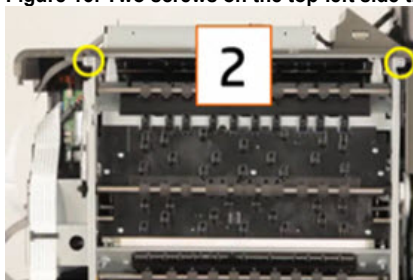
- c. In the small compartment where the control panel assembly used to sit, remove the three screws (as shown below).

Figure 15: Remove three screws in the small compartment where the control panel used to sit



- d. Push the scanner assembly towards the left side and partially lift it so that it is on top of the scanner support bracket.
6. Remove the two screws on the top-left side of the printer that attach to the top cover (shown below).

Figure 16: Two screws on the top-left side that attach to the top cover



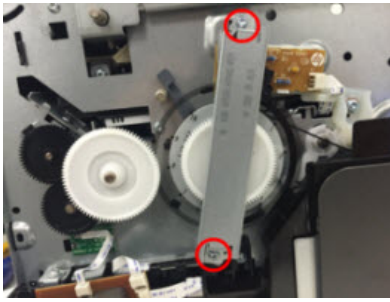
7. Partially remove the top cover (you will have to detach the top cover from the front cover).
8. Remove the screw on the front cover (shown below), and then remove the front cover.

Figure 17: Screw on front cover



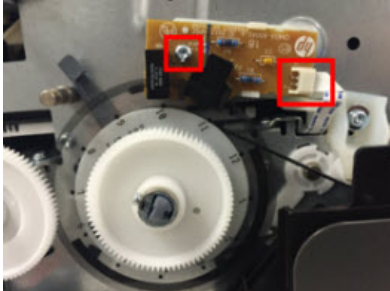
9. Remove the encoder-wheel brace by removing the two screws that are holding it in place.

Figure 18: Two screws on encoder-wheel brace



10. On the encoder-wheel PCA, disconnect the FFC and remove the screw. Then carefully remove the PCA.

Figure 19: Screw and FFC on encoder-wheel PCA



11. Using a clean, damp, lint-free cloth, carefully wipe the encoder wheel while gently turning the gear.

NOTE: Be careful not to scratch or damage the wheel.

Figure 20: Clean the encoder wheel



12. After you have cleaned the encoder wheel, reassemble the parts in the following order:
- Encoder wheel PCA
 - Encoder wheel brace
 - Front cover
 - Top cover
 - Left-front and left-rear covers
 - Rear cover